

GENDER



BENDERS

Pravin Menon vs Ruby Tiwari

Display Filename Extensions



Pravin wondered, "I hope it's not very difficult." On hearing about the task, he visibly relaxed. He clicked 'My Computer' and opened the C: drive, and accessed Tools > Folder Options > View from the menu bar. He then started to hunt under the various menus without luck. After five minutes, we gave him a big hint—'Folder Options'! Pravin saw the light: he unchecked "Hide extensions for known file types." Well, we have a winner!



Ruby was as apprehensive as Pravin. And when she started to search, she looked all over except at the right place. After three minutes or so, Ruby had an idea—she right-clicked files and chose 'Rename', renaming two files she identified as MS Word files with the .doc extension. However, Ruby's joy was short-lived, as we pointed out that it wasn't the right method to arrive at the answer. We decided to help her a bit and gave her the same hint. That done, Ruby nailed the solution in almost no time, taking just a few seconds more than Pravin had.

cards use the MagicGate protection technology, which, as you've guessed, is another proprietary Sony technology.

The fact is Sony has been pushing its own storage formats for a little too long now, and it could land them in serious trouble—customers are more likely to choose a product that offers compatibility with easily available, and cheaper,

storage formats.

Besides, SanDisk's own MicroSD (originally called TransFlash) Flash cards have been adopted by the SD Association and the SD memory card standards group. The MicroSD measures just 1.5 x 1.1 x 0.1 cm—smaller than the Memory Stick Micro—and SanDisk have promised to launch a 2 GB MicroSD chip as early as 2006! Talk about

a conflict of interests!

In a game where the customer is king, Sony sure has been walking the tightrope with its mobile storage solutions.

Remember the Memory Stick Duo, Memory Stick Pro, and Memory Stick Duo Pro (or was it Pro Duo)? Nothing vexes us customers more than having to shell out more money than usual for a memory card that works only on our own devices—we can't connect it to a friend's device, we can't connect a friend's card to our device, we can't use common card readers, and generally get bugged when we see our friends buy an SD or Micro Flash card with more capacity for Rs 2,000 less! Welcome to proprietary hell!

Murmurs have been heard that Sony is not looking to keep this new format proprietary, but the fact is, no-one else is going to give Sony the chance gloat, "Ha! Even our biggest competitors use our technology"! Even if a competitor does tie up with Sony, they're not likely to pay licensing fees and migrate their entire product line to Sony's format now are they?

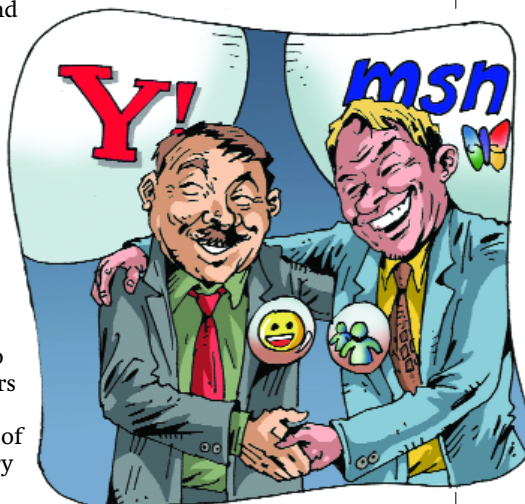
The bottomline is that Sony's proprietary formats seem doomed, and it's going to take a lot more than a "theoretical" capacity of 32 GB to bring its competitors to their knees, begging for a piece of the Sony proprietary pie!

BROTHERS IN 'ARMS'!

MSN, Yahoo!, Bhai-Bhai?

Yes, it's not just a rumour. Microsoft (MSN Messenger) and Yahoo! (Y! Messenger) announced in mid-October 2005 that their respective IM services would be interoperable by mid-2006. This means you will now be able to add your Yahoo! Messenger buddies into your MSN Messenger list and vice-versa, and also chat, send select emoticons and see their online/offline status. This is expected to take their joint, directly-connected, IM community to over 27 crore!

However, before you start popping open the champagne (or cola) bottles in celebration, you should know that all this has been promised earlier, by Yahoo!, MSN and even AOL, and not much has happened since. However, keeping in mind that this is an official press



nVidia C51

Usually, a buzzword is something that exists in the common man's domain. Something like nVidia C51 does not. In fact, it hasn't quite entered the geek domain as yet.

Well, the C51? It's a chipset that promises to beat the pants off every other one. The specifications released by the company created quite a buzz before it was released. So what does the C51 do? OK, here's the

device in action: it has four DIMM slots for DDR memory, a PCI bus interface, a SATA interface and an onboard battery that will last for 16 hours before losing all the data on the card. That's a huge amount of time before you need to rush in for a recharge. Still don't get it? Just plug one of these heavyweights into your machine and feel the buzz. You'll figure out why it's a buzzword!

Buzzword
of the MONTH